for attacks against [Indian] military targets.'[157] According to a 2002 report by the International Crisis Group, Lashkar and Jaish-e-Mohammed were collecting almost 5 million pounds annually in British mosques, mainly from the Kashmiri diaspora.[158] These estimates are impossible to verify, but even if Lashkar raised only one-fifth of the Crisis Group estimate, it would still constitute a substantial amount.

The case of Shafiq-ur Rehman illustrates the type of connections the group had to the United Kingdom through MDI in the mid- to late-1990s as well as the difficulty of separating support for MDI's social welfare operations from Lashkar's militant ones and the British government's evolving perception of the threat these activities posed. Rehman came to the UK in 1993 to work as a maulvi with the Jamiat Ahl-e-Hadith. In 1998 the authorities denied his application to remain indefinitely, meaning Rehman would be deported, on the grounds that he was 'involved with an Islamic terrorist organization Markaz Dawa Al Irshad' and hence represented 'a danger to national security.' Rehman appealed the decision via the Special Immigration Appeals Commission [SIAC]. During the ensuing proceedings in 1999, the government argued:

> The Security Service assesses that while Ur Rehman and his United Kingdom-based followers are unlikely to carry out any acts of violence in this country, his activities directly support terrorism in the Indian subcontinent and are likely to continue unless he is deported. Ur Rehman has also been partly responsible for an increase in the number of Muslims in the United Kingdom who have undergone some form of militant training, including indoctrination into extremist beliefs and at least some basic weapons training. The Security Service is concerned that the presence of returned jihad trainees in the United Kingdom may encourage the radicalisation of the British Muslim community. His activities in the United Kingdom are intended to further the cause of a terrorist organisation abroad.

The Home Secretary also alleged Rehman was a 'personal contact of Mohammed Saeed, the worldwide leader of MDI and LT [Lashkar].'[159] Rehman admitted to attending an MDI conference in Pakistan and to raising funds, but argued the money was for educational and welfare projects in Pakistan and that he was not aware it was used for military operations. The SIAC noted Rehman's statement that he 'sympathised with [Lashkar's] aims' in Kashmir and recognized that he had 'provided sponsorship, information and advice to persons going to Pakistan for the forms of training which may have included militant or extremist training,'